

Accommodation Tips in New Zealand

A practical guide for international students



Student-friendly neighbourhoods close to everything.



A comfortable space to study, relax and feel at home.



Explore everything New Zealand has to offer.



8. Helpful tip

If you are new to New Zealand, starting with student accommodation or homestay can make the transition easier before moving into a private flat later.

1. Know your accommodation options

- **Student halls:** Great for first-year students who want convenience and a social environment.
- **Homestay:** Live with a local family and enjoy extra support while settling in.
- **Private rental or flatting:** Good for independence, but make sure you understand the costs and rules before signing anything.

2. Set your budget early

- Plan for rent, bond, food, transport, power, internet, and personal expenses.
- Check what is included in the rent, as some places include utilities and others do not.
- Accommodation costs can vary a lot depending on the city and location.

3. Choose the right location

- Look at travel time to campus, access to public transport, and nearby supermarkets or essentials.
- A cheaper room further away may cost more in time and transport.
- Think about safety, convenience, and your daily routine.

4. Inspect before you commit

- If possible, view the property in person or request a video tour.
- Check heating, ventilation, bathroom condition, kitchen space, storage, and internet access.
- Ask about flatmates, house rules, and who to contact for repairs.

5. Understand the agreement

- Read the tenancy or accommodation agreement carefully before signing.
- Know the rent amount, payment dates, notice period, and bond terms.
- Keep copies of receipts, messages, and signed documents.

6. Watch out for scams

- Be cautious if a listing seems too cheap or pressures you to pay quickly.
- Never send money without confirming the property is genuine.
- Use trusted platforms and ask your education provider if you are unsure.

7. Quick move-in checklist

- ✓ Take photos of the room or property when you move in
- ✓ Confirm what furniture and appliances are included
- ✓ Learn how rubbish, recycling, and mail work
- ✓ Save emergency and landlord or accommodation contacts
- ✓ Know where to get support if something goes wrong